

Help us improve our data science EPQ course

Project information for students

Your school or college is one of the first to use a new data science course, built by the Raspberry Pi Foundation to help you prepare for your Extended Project Qualification (EPQ). Because it is new, we want to find out how well it works, and we would like to hear from you. This sheet explains what we are asking, what we would do with your answers, and what you can say no to. Please read it before you start.

Who is asking?

The Raspberry Pi Foundation, an education charity. We made the course and we run the Ada Computer Science website where it lives. Your responses will also be shared with the University of Cambridge for research purposes.

What would I be doing?

You will work through the course either way. What we are asking you to do is give us some feedback along the way.

When	What we would like you to do	Roughly how long
September 2026	Fill in a short survey before you start the course. It asks about you, your experience with programming and computers, and what you hope to get from the EPQ.	15 minutes
September to December 2026	Work through the ten units, about one a week, with a support session each week with your teacher. The units include some short questions asking how confident you feel and whether you got something right.	Part of the course
December 2026	Fill in a second survey about what you thought of the course: what helped, what did not, and anything that got in your way.	15 minutes
April 2027	Fill in a third short survey about how your EPQ is going.	15 minutes
June or July 2027, after your exams	Some students will be invited to a group discussion about their experience. This is optional even if you are invited, and there is a thank-you gift for taking part.	About an hour

We will also look at how the course was used on the website: when people logged in, which pages they looked at, and how many practice questions they tried. This is the kind of information the website records anyway, as the privacy policy explains.

Do I have to take part?

No. Taking part is entirely up to you, and nobody will mind if you say no.

- You can do the course without filling in any surveys
- You can skip any question you do not want to answer
- You can stop at any time, without giving a reason

- If you would rather we did not include your activity on the Ada CS website in the evaluation, tell your teacher or email us and we will leave it out

Your decision will not affect your EPQ grade, your other work, or what your teacher thinks of you. Your EPQ is marked by your school or college and your exam board. We have nothing to do with that, and we will not tell your teacher what you said in any of the surveys.

Will anyone know it was me?

The surveys do not ask for your name. Instead, you make a short code, from the first two letters of your mother's or guardian's first name and the day of the month you were born, so we can match your three surveys to each other without knowing who you are. We do ask which school or college you are at.

We may quote what you write in reports, on our website, or in printed materials, but never with anything that would identify you or your school.

One thing to be aware of: because you use an account to do the course, we can see which students are in your class's group on the website. That means your activity on the site is not anonymous to us in the way your survey answers are. We only use your site activity to count things like how many students reach various points of the course.

If you join a focus group, the other students there will hear what you say. We will ask everyone to keep it to themselves, but we cannot guarantee it.

What do I get out of it?

Nothing directly, apart from a thank-you gift if you join a focus group. But you are among the first people to use this course, and what you tell us will change it for the students who come after you. If something is confusing or broken, telling us is how it gets fixed.

Your rights

- You can choose not to take part, and you can change your mind later.
- You can ask us what information we hold about you and get a copy of it.
- You can ask us to correct or delete any of the information we hold about you.
- To have your survey answers deleted, tell us your code and we will find and remove them. If they have already been added into a total that cannot be pulled apart, we will explain that.
- If you are unhappy with how we have used your information, please tell us. You can also complain to the Information Commissioner's Office at ico.org.uk.

Questions?

Ask your teacher, or email us at impact@raspberrypi.org

You can read the full privacy policy for the website at <https://adacomputerscience.org/privacy>.

Thank you, and good luck with your EPQ.